



Java NIO

It's interesting to NIO

The book starts with a rather bland opening line: "Let's talk I/O. No, no come back. It's not really all that dull." Come back, shouldn't we? As a Java programmer, you cannot really be blamed for putting I/O concerns on the backburner. After all, JVMs make programmers fret on extracting every ounce of CPU performance they could manage, thus relegating I/O optimization to neglect. However, with time, JVMs have evolved enough to run bytecodes at speeds approaching native code such as C/C++. This means that the classic case of I/O being the major performance bottleneck is now truer for Java than ever. And here, Java's I/O classes haven't been of much help.

This is where the New I/O (NIO) framework of Java comes into picture. NIO classes enable you to pack Java applications with efficient I/O routines for large

buffers, non-contiguous read-writes, channels, memory-mapped files, etc. Ron Hitchen's *Java NIO* gives you a comprehensive coverage of the topic. The book makes for an interesting and fruitful read.

It can be roughly divided into four sections: Chapters one to four introduce and elaborate the I/O concepts, namely, buffers, channels and selectors. Chapter five deals with Java regular expressions Application Programming Interface (API). Chapter six talks about charsets, another mystery for programmers deploying software over multiple architectures. The book also packs in appendices on NIO

and Java Native Interface (JNI), selectable channel Shared Programming Interface (SPI), and an NIO quick API reference.

The book uses very focused code examples to illustrate core topics, as well as asides such as file holes. Diagrams are intuitive and simple. Another nice feature is simple Unified Modeling Language (UML) class diagrams that give you a quick overview of various classes in the NIO framework.

The final word—*Java NIO* is highly recommended to intermediate and advanced Java developers

who want to keep abreast with the latest without going through voluminous tomes.



Publisher: Shroff Publishers and Distributors Pvt Ltd ■ **Authors:** Ron Hitchens ■ **Phone:** 022-27634290 ■ **Fax:** 022-27683375
E-mail: spd@vsnl.com ■ **Web site:** www.oreilly.com ■ **Price:** Rs 275
Rating: ★★★★★



SAMS Teach Yourself Adobe Photoshop CS in 24 Hours

The clock is ticking...

The *SAMS Teach Yourself* series of books is widely popular because of the ease with which they get you started on the subject. *SAMS Teach Yourself Adobe Photoshop CS in 24 Hours* treads the same path, and is good enough at making you understand what Photoshop CS does. Photoshop CS is the latest version of the premier product from Adobe—the sweetheart of graphic professionals across the world. This book was one of the first few written on Photoshop CS. In fact, it was written on the beta version of the product.

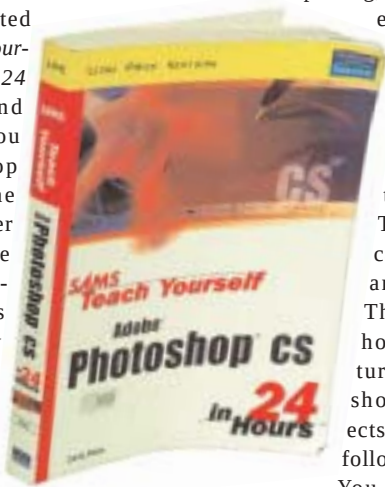
This 500-pages book is divided into seven sections.

The first deals with basics such as opening, saving, selections, etc. The second segment talks about layers, masks and paths, the third about filters and the fourth talks about text and plug-ins. The fifth part takes care of photo-repair and enhancements. The sixth shows you how to print your pictures and use Photoshop CS for Web projects. A useful appendix follows at the end.

You can download the

images used in the book from the publisher's Web site. This makes learning easier, as you can try out things explained on the same photographs. However, all the screenshots are taken on a Mac PC. Windows users might not be able to relate what they see in the book, and what they find on their monitor screen.

Another good aspect is the exercises given at the end of the book. Trying out these ensures faster learning. Though this book is in black and white, there are 16 coloured, high quality pages with some screenshots of what Photoshop CS can do. To sum up, here is a decent book if you don't know much about Photoshop, and want an overview of its features.



Publisher: Pearson Education (Singapore) Pvt Ltd ■ **Author:** Carla Rose ■ **Distributor:** Pearson Education India ■ **Phone:** 011-2146067 ■ **E-mail:** info@pearsoned.co.in ■ **Web site:** www.sampublishing.com ■ **Price:** Rs 350
Rating: ★★★★★